

Lab Meeting Guide

How to Prepare and Present

Jeong Lab

2026-06-15

Jeong Lab's Vision

Three principles behind our work:



Efficient

Does more with less data
& compute



Integrative

Connects messy,
fragmented biomedical
data



Clinically grounded

Actionable at the
pediatric bedside

Pediatric Precision Medicine

Our Goal for You

Jeong Lab wants to help you become:

- a great **story-teller**
- a great **scientist**
- a great **team player**

Our Lab Meetings Are Where You Practice Story-telling

Lab Meeting Goals

- Lab meetings are how we **learn from each other**
- 30–50 min talks that are **clear**, **visual**, and **concise**
- This guide: the format we follow

Why Your Story Matters

- Whether academia or industry — **presentations are inevitable**
- Job talks, big or small — you will always need to present
- Science isn't just proving a hypothesis with evidence
- **It's how you tell your story**

Two Components of Story-telling

Your presentation = two skills:

1. **Speaking** — delivering fluently and confidently
2. **Slide deck** — creating clear, visual, compelling slides

This guide focuses on **slide decks**.

- I can teach what I'm good at — and I believe I've built strong decks
- My goal: everyone in the lab becomes a **great slide-maker**

The Format

1. **Introduction** — What, Why, How
2. **Methods** — Only what you'll explain (details go to backup)
3. **Results** — Title = take-home message
4. **Acknowledgements** — Names + funding

Introduction

What — Why — How

What

What **problem** are you solving?

Why

Why does it **matter**?

How

How do you **approach** it?

Continuation Rule

If this is a **follow-up** talk:

- Start with 1–3 slides summarizing the previous presentation (a rough guide, not a hard rule — use more if needed)
- Remind the audience where you left off
- Then proceed with new material

Methods

Keep It Minimal



Do

- Show the pipeline/workflow as a **figure**
- Only include what you will actually explain
- Complex details → backup slides



Don't

- Copy-paste the entire methods section
- Show equations without intuition
- Include steps you won't discuss

One Figure > Many Words



Source: [Wikipedia](#)

If you can show it visually, **don't write a paragraph**.

Results

Slide Title = Take-Home Message

 Bad title

"The benchmark results"

 Good title

"Gene X increases expression 3-fold under stress"

The audience reads the title first. **Make it count.**

Results: Practical Tips

- One main point per slide
- Highlight the key region of a figure
- If a figure needs 2 min to explain, **simplify it**
- Tables: max 4–5 rows visible at a time

Acknowledgements

Give Credit

- Name **collaborators** and their contributions
- List **funding sources** (grant numbers)
- Mention lab members who helped

General Rules

Be Understood

- **Know your audience** — adjust jargon level
- **30–50 minutes** — plan accordingly
- **Less text, more visuals** — no one reads walls of text
- **Expect questions throughout** — not just at the end
- **Practice** — at least once out loud

Slide Design

Keep

- Large fonts
- High-contrast colors
- One idea per slide
- Consistent layout

Avoid

- Full sentences as bullet points
- Tiny fonts / dense tables
- Animations without purpose

Using AI?

Using AI to make slides is fine — just **review it carefully** for hallucinations and slop.

You can't blame the AI for a mistake — **it's on you.**

Time Management

Duration	Slides
30 min	20–25
50 min	30–40

~1.5 min per content slide + discussion time

Checklist Before Presenting

Must

- Audience can follow without reading every word?
- Each result slide title states the finding?

Optional

- Backup slides ready for anticipated questions?
- Practiced within the time limit?

Timeline

- Presentation day: **Monday**
- Discuss with your mentor **before Friday** to get feedback
- Apply the feedback where possible

Recommended File Format

Use whatever tool you like — the only rule:

it must be a file you can push to GitHub.

- PowerPoint — `.pptx`
- Apple Keynote — `.key`
- LaTeX / Beamer — `.tex` → `.pdf`
- Quarto — `.qmd` (used for this guide)
- Anything else — just export a `.pdf`

Google Slides isn't a file — export to `.pdf` / `.pptx` before pushing.

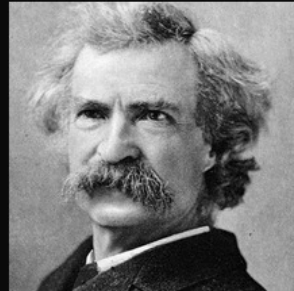
Sharing

- Lab meeting slides are shared via PR to **jeonglab-bcm:/labmeeting**
- Submit your PR after your presentation

During the Seminar

- **Q & A happens throughout** — ask whenever something is unclear
- Don't be nervous if you don't understand something right away — be patient, ask, and we'll work through it together

Q & A



He who asks is a fool for five minutes, but he who does not ask remains a fool forever.

~ Mark Twain

AZ QUOTES

Source: azquotes.com